

makes a difference between a nice looking desktop and a 'wow' desktop. To change text colour, go into the customise tab and click Change label text colour. A standard palette will open allowing you to change colour according to your liking.

Fences layouts

There are a few default layouts available within Fences. Such as the "Left & Right" or "All bottom" layout etc. To view layout options go to the Fences

Fences pro

The pro version of this software which is available for \$10 has a host of added features.

- Auto organise icons by file type
- Create rules for auto organising into Fences like recent, most used, etc.
- Further Fence customisation

tab in the application interface and select the appropriate layout from the drop down list. Once you select one you can take a peek at the desktop and see how it looks. The option to revert to previous layout is available right there.

Change icon size

Some people prefer huge chunky icons while others prefer to maintain the look of their desktop and want icons to

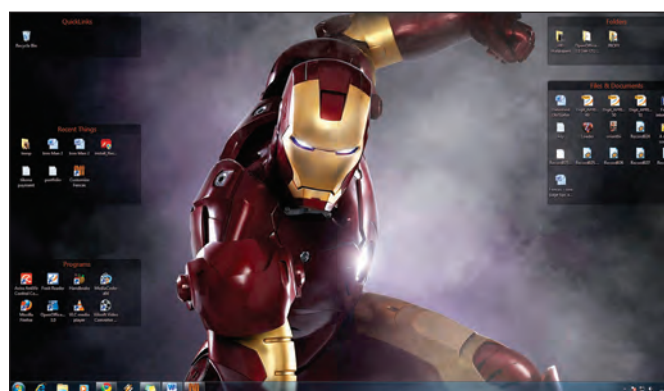


A neatly sorted desktop

be barely visible. Fences allows you to change icon size too. Right click on any Fence and hover your cursor over View. Here you'll find three sizes to choose from Large Medium and Classic. The latter being the smallest size.

Autodesk Homestyler

The Autodesk Homestyler (formerly Project Dragonfly) is an online home design software that is easy and intuitive and likely steal away a lot of Google SketchUp fans. You can make quick designs to preview plans for your own home or your client within minutes, save them online and access them



The Left and Right layout applied by Fences

from anywhere with just an internet connection.

Getting started

You can get started with your designs immediately, but to save them you'll need an account. Fill in your details but make sure that the email id is valid. Don't forget to check the 'Terms of use' agreement box before you click on Create Account & Sign in button.

If you wish to avoid the hassle of remembering another password, Homestyler lets you register with any of the most popular email and social networking accounts like Gmail, Yahoo, Windows Live and Facebook. Just click on any of the large buttons below and fill in your account details. This is really useful for designers because Homestyler syncs your account with this one

and allows you to share designs with any of the buddies in your list with just a few clicks. I advise a little caution, though, because my browser just told me that the Facebook link is spurious and seems to connect to a phishing site instead.

Arranging

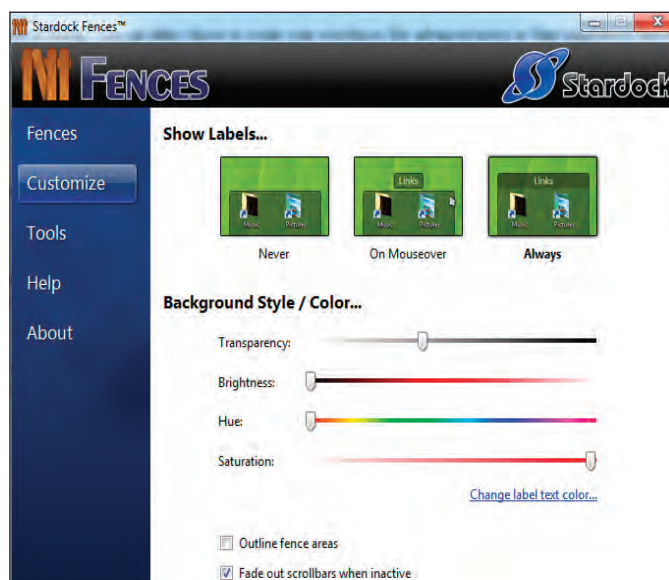
All of Homestyler's controls are on the right. The vertical menu on the right is the catalogue which allows you to (a) build the basic floor plan with square or 'L' shaped rooms, (b)

Arrange items like furniture etc. in the rooms you've made (c) Stretch surfaces as landscapes and (d) even incorporate branded stuff into your design like Kohler kitchen sinks, Merillat kitchen cabinets, etc.

Just left of the vertical menu are the controls that allow you to toggle between 2D and 3D, zoom in and out, view your design full screen, etc. Now that you're in and figured out the basics, let's get designing.

Creating new designs

Click on the 'New' button in the set of tools above to begin a new design. You could create a new design from scratch or start off with one of the templates already provided. Ideally one should create a room, add furniture and finishing touches and then switch to 3D to take a more realistic look at the design.



Fences interface showing various customisation options